> Senior separatist leaders Mohammad Yasin Malik, chairman JKLF, and Shabir Ahmad Shah, president of Democratic Freedom Party (DFP) visited the bereaved family to offer their condolences. Addressing the people there, Shah said the way Irshad was murdered it clearly indicated that Kashmiri youth cannot go to any Indian state. 'Their only fault is that they are Kashmiri,' he said.
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> Shah alleged that on one side government of India is talking about peace and on the other side leaving no stone unturned to murder Kashmiri youth. The DFP president was placed under house arrest. JKLF chairman Mohammad Yasin Malik visited the residence of Irshad immediately after his return from New Delhi. Accompanied by other party leaders, he took part in protest demonstrations. Addressing the people, Malik strongly condemned the killing. He asked as to what crime Irshad had committed.' Is being a Kashmiri the biggest crime', the JKLF chairman asked. He said the slain engineer had qualified the interview for a job in Delhi on merit. 'But he was denied the job for being a Kashmiri. When he was about to return his home, he was killed by unidentified men', Malik said.

It appears from this report, and from the arrest of Irom Sharmila and the police action in Delhi against those demonstrating in solidarity with her and against the AFSPA, that being a certain kind of Kashmiri or having Manipuri or identifiably 'North-Eastern' features is in fact a crime in the capital of the Indian republic. The pre-cognitive faculties of the State know that 'people like that' are potential subversives, and that no effort should be spared in neutralizing them. If this does result in the occasional execution of a Mohammad Afzal Guru or the death on the streets of Delhi of an Irshad Ahmad Lone, then it is way too small a price to pay for the integrity and security of the Indian State.

It is said that it took the massacres of Algerians in Paris in 1961 for a generation of French Intellectuals to begin to understand the actual nature of French colonialism in Algeria. How many Kashmiris will need to die in Delhi's streets and in Tihar (since the number of dead in Kashmir does not seem to have much of an effect) for the Indian intelligentsia to wake up to the fact that the Indian State is a colonial State, and it acts like those of any occupying power in Kashmir and significant parts of the North-East?

In his written statement to his lawyer Sushil Kumar, Afzal points out how Indian security officers routinely extorted money from him because he was a 'surrendered militant' who had not become a special police officer (SPO). In this sordid tale of greed, where different police officers demand varying sums of money after torturing Afzal, lies one of the secrets of Indian 'occupation' in Kashmir. Our army is in Kashmir, Indian soldiers and countless Kashmiris are dying in Kashmir, also because there is money to be made in this business. 'Terrorists' are just as necessary a part of this equation. Because 'terrorists' become 'surrendered terrorists', and 'surrendered terrorists' are excellent